

# Treaty of Versailles

One of the first challenges that Weimar republic faced ⇒ announcement of the terms of the TOV in May 1919.

German people ⇒ not told that if war carried on ⇒ Germany would have eventually been invaded by its enemies

⇒ vast majority though → German army had ended the war undefeated and even celebrated return of the troops

Without knowing truth ⇒ German people were expecting a negotiated treaty ⇒ in which they would be treated with respect as equals.

⇒ were shocked and angry when the terms were announced.

→ called the treaty a 'diktat' or a dictated peace forced upon Germans.

Ebert himself ⇒ very reluctant to sign treaty ⇒ but he had no choice but to do so on 28th June 1919

Treaty ⇒ undermined Weimar republic + poisoned attitudes of many Germans towards it ⇒ in such a way that it eventually brought the Republic down.

Minds of many Germans ⇒ Ebert and Weimar politicians ⇒ were forever to blame for the treaty

⇒ were often called 'November criminals'

Most Germans ⇒ also chose to believe in the Dolchstoß Theory > or that German army had been stabbed in the back by the socialist and liberal politicians ⇒ that agreed to the armistice in November 1918.

→ as unpopularity grew ⇒ extremist ideas, violence, voices ⇒ took root in the country

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